

7.3 7th-Gen Consoles And The Future Of Computer Gaming

Gaming has moved from being played on standalone consoles to computers—and then back to consoles that crunch numbers faster than regular computers. Many today believe the future of gaming lies in consoles, and that computers will soon give way to their snazzier and more powerful cousins. If you look at the present crop of gaming consoles, this does not seem a far-fetched proposition.

A look into the new-age (7th-generation) gaming consoles reveals not just the astounding computing capabilities of these beasts but also the newer processors that will take graphics technology to the next level. The processing power of the PS3 is said to be in the range



Powerful multi-core processors are the heart of new consoles

of 2.1 teraflops, or 2,100 gigaflops: to put this in perspective, mid-to high-end PCs today can manage just around 8 gigaflops!

With multi-core processors at the heart of these machines, the consoles will also house separate PPU's that will take up the onus of calculating the Physics in games. Needless to say, the graphics quality supported by these machines will be near life-like.

The PS3 and Xbox 360 will both come with removable hard disks, while the Nintendo Revolution is said to have a compact Flash drive that houses around 500 MB data. Not very large, but then, Nintendo is banking on online and thin gaming to pave the way for the future. Every aspect of the consoles—right from the technology under the boot to the ergonomics—will push the limits of the future.